ARTICLES OF ASSOCIATION OF ITALIAN WOMEN IN KOREA (IWK)

Article 1: Name of the Association

The name of the association shall be: **"Italian Women in Korea - IWK"** (hereinafter referred to as "the Association").

Article 2: Legal Status

The Association is a non-profit organization established under the laws of South Korea (임의단체, *Imuidanche*). It shall operate without the purpose of distributing profit to its members.

Article 3: Office Address

The official address of the Association shall be designated and, if necessary, modified by the Board of Directors. The Association may establish additional offices or branches as deemed appropriate. The Association's official address(es) will be published on the Association's website and/or social media pages.

Article 4: Membership

1. **Regular Membership**: Membership is open to Italian women residing in South Korea, as well as to women of any other nationalities who reside in South Korea, who demonstrate a proven and fluent knowledge of the Italian language(hereafter referred as "the members"). Regular members have the right to vote at the General Assembly and may be elected to the Board of Directors. The founding members are automatically designated as regular members.

2. **Associate Members**: Associate membership is open to any other individual who demonstrate a strong connection to Italy and a genuine interest in supporting the Association's mission. They may attend the General Assembly **without the right to vote** and are **not eligible for board positions, including the President**.

3. **Honorary Members**: The General Assembly may appoint honorary members. Honorary members may attend the General Assembly **without the right to vote** and are **not eligible for board positions, including the President**. They may be invited to board meetings upon request of the board. Honorary members are exempt from membership fees.

4. **Admission**: Membership applications shall be submitted to the Board of Directors for approval.

5. **Rights and Obligations**:

    - Members have the right to participate in the Association's activities and, in the case of regular members, to vote in General Assembly meetings.

- Members are required to **uphold the values of the Association** and are subject to annual **membership fees** as determined by the Board of Directors.

6. **Termination**: Regular membership may be terminated by resignation, non-payment of fees, or expulsion for conduct contrary to the Association's objectives, subject to the resolution of the Board of Directors. Regular membership is also automatically terminated upon permanently leaving South Korea.

Article 5: Objectives

The objectives of the Association are:

1. To **promote solidarity and networking** among the members in South Korea.
2. To **organize cultural, professional, and social initiatives** that enhance the personal and collective growth of its members.
3. To **provide guidance and support** to the members.
4. To **strengthen cultural ties between Italy and South Korea** through events, collaborations, and educational projects.
5. To **advocate for the interests and well-being** of the members.
6. To **collaborate with the Embassy of Italy in South Korea, the Italian Cultural Institute**, and other relevant institutions to advance shared objectives.
7. To **foster mentorship and skill-sharing** among members, leveraging their professional and personal expertise.
8. To support charity initiatives and projects.

Article 6: Governance

1. **General Assembly**:
    - The General Assembly is the supreme governing body of the Association. It consists of all members and meets at least once a year. **Only regular members have the right to vote.**
    - The General Assembly approves the annual budget, elects the Board of Directors, and makes decisions on major issues, including amendments to these Articles.
    - **Quorum**: The General Assembly is validly constituted on the first call when more than half of the regular members are present in person or virtually, and on the second call, with any number of members present.
    - Decisions are made by an **absolute majority vote**, unless otherwise specified in these Articles.
2. **Board of Directors**:

- The Board of Directors is responsible for the management of the Association. It consists of **up to five members**, including a President, two Vice-Presidents, Treasurer, and Secretary.
- The Board is elected by the General Assembly for a term of **two years**, renewable.
- The Board meets regularly to oversee the Association's activities and finances.

3. **President**:
   - The President legally represents the Association and acts as its spokesperson.
   - The President chairs the Board of Directors and the General Assembly.
4. **Honorary President**: The Ambassador of the Italian Republic in South Korea H.E. Emilia Gatto, shall serve as **Honorary President** for the duration of her mandate.
5. **Honorary Vice-President:** The Cultural Attaché of the Embassy of Italy in Seoul, Ms. Erika Sfascia, shall serve as Honorary Vice-President for the duration of her mandate.
6. **Guests**: Members may invite guests to Association meetings. Guests **have neither voting rights nor advisory roles**. The Board can decide on exclusivity of certain events upon vote.
7. **Language**: the official language of the Association and Association activities is Italian. The Board can decide on using any other vehicular language to enhance the Association's objectives and support its mission.

Article 7: Finances

1. **Sources of Income**: The Association's income shall derive from membership fees, donations, grants, and revenue from events or activities. The annual membership fees shall be indicated on the Association's website and/or social media pages, and may be increased subject to a resolution by the Board of Directors.
2. **Bank Account**:
   - The Association shall maintain a dedicated bank account for all financial transactions. The President and Treasurer each shall have signing authority.
   - In the absence of a bank account in the name of the Association, a bank account in the name of the President may be used, provided it is exclusively dedicated to the Association's finances.
   - As an alternative, particularly during the early stages, the Association may adopt a simplified cash-based system managed by the Treasurer, with regular reporting to members.
   - The Board may also consider the use of an e-wallet, registered under the name of a relevant individual, such as the representative of the organization, instead of

a bank account. In such case, the same rules provided in paragraphs 1 and 2 of this Article shall apply.

3. **Financial Reporting:** The Treasurer shall prepare an annual financial report for approval by the General Assembly. The fiscal year of the Association shall commence on 1 January, and end on 31 December. Provided, however, that the first fiscal year shall commence on 12 November 2025 and end on 31 December 2025.
4. **Reimbursement of Expenses:**
    - Reimbursement of any expense and/or cost actually incurred in connection with the activities of the Association shall be permitted under prior approval by the Board of Directors. In cases where such approval was not obtained due to reasonable cause, the member may seek retroactive approval by submitting relevant documentation to the Board of Directors. All reimbursement requests must be accompanied by appropriate documentation, including but not limited to receipts, invoices, and a detailed description of the purpose of the expenditure.
    - Reimbursement of expenses and/or costs shall be made in accordance with applicable laws and regulations. The Board of Directors may establish additional rules, policies, and/or procedures governing such reimbursement as necessary.

Article 8: Amendments to the Articles of Association

Any amendments to these Articles must be approved by an **absolute majority vote** of the General Assembly.

Article 9: Dissolution

1. The Association shall have unlimited duration and may be dissolved by a **two-thirds majority vote** of the General Assembly.
2. Upon dissolution, remaining assets shall be transferred to a **non-profit organization with similar objectives**, as determined by the General Assembly.

Article 10: Effective Date

These Articles of Association shall enter into force upon approval by the founding members.

Article 11: Collaborations

The Association shall actively seek to establish and maintain collaborative relationships with:

1. The **Embassy of Italy in South Korea**, to promote the interests of the members and cultural exchange;
2. The **Italian Cultural Institute in South Korea**;

3. **Other Italian and South Korean institutions** (e.g., universities, cultural centers) to support joint initiatives; and
4. **Other associations and networks** aligned with its mission, both locally and internationally.

Transitional Provisions

The founding members shall constitute the first Board of Directors and shall hold office until the first Annual General Meeting.

The following founding members shall serve in the following respective offices, as an exception of Article 6.2., until that time:

- Sara Ferri, **Co-President**
- Sook Hee Hong, **Co-President**
- Adele Vitale, **Co-President**
- Giulia Ceccacci, **Treasurer**
- Adriana D'Alterio, **Secretary**

These transitional provisions shall cease to have effect after that meeting.